

innovations are built. Some of the more famous examples include steam, electricity, internal combustion engines, and information technology.¹⁶ We would add blockchain technology to this list. While such a claim may appear grand to some, that is the scale of the innovation before us.

As a general purpose technology, blockchain technology includes private blockchains that are going to have a profound impact on many industries *and* public blockchains beyond Bitcoin that are growing like gangbusters. The realm of public blockchains and their native assets is most relevant to the innovative investor, as private blockchains have not yielded an entirely new asset class that is investable to the public.

WHERE IS BLOCKCHAIN TECHNOLOGY IN THE HYPE CYCLE?

By now it will be clear to the innovative investor that the blockchain technology space is still working itself out and will continue to do so for years to come. Captivating technologies have a gravitational pull that brings in new minds with varied perspectives and that will push the boundaries of the technology.

The progression of a new technology, and the way it evolves as it gains mental mindshare, is at the core of Gartner's Hype Cycle for Emerging Technologies (Gartner is a leading technology research and advisory firm),¹⁷ which displays five common stages of technology.¹⁸